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# TikTok adds new parental controls, tools for creators

TikTok announced on Wednesday that it's releasing a slew of new features, including enhanced parental controls, additional tools for creators, and a new interactive well-being feature. It also [publicly launched Footnotes](#), its fact-checking system.

The social network is bringing new parental controls to Family Pairing, its feature that allows parents to link their accounts with their teen's account to customize safety settings. Parents can now block specific accounts for their teen's account. Blocked accounts can't interact with the teen, and the teen won't see the account's content in their feed.

IMAGE CREDITS:

JAKUB PORZYCKI / NURPHOTO / GETTY IMAGES

Parents will also now automatically be notified when their teen uploads a public video, story, or photo. TikTok says this will help parents stay informed about what their teen is posting without disrupting their creativity.

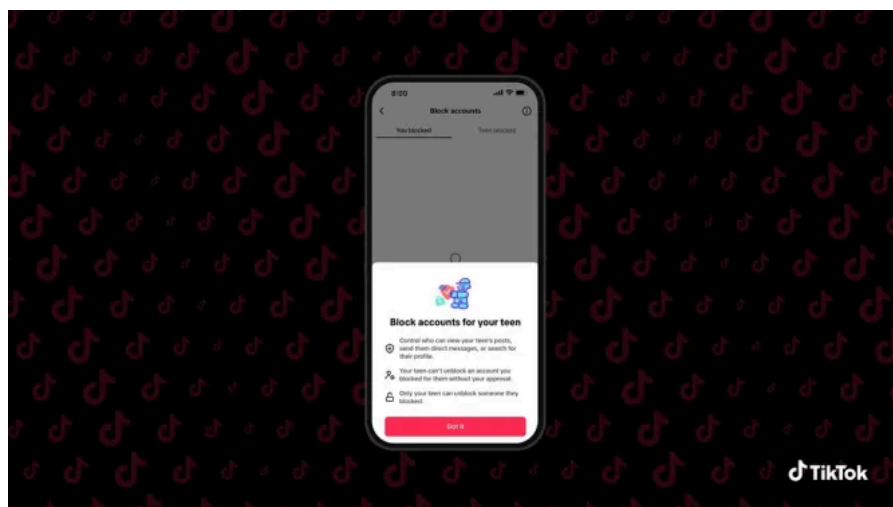


IMAGE CREDITS:TIKTOK

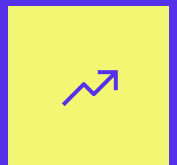
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Parents now get more visibility into the privacy settings that their teen selects. For example, they can see if their teen (aged 16 to 17) has enabled downloads for their content or if their following list is visible to others.

TikTok is also launching “Creator Care Mode,” which automatically filters all comments identified as offensive, inappropriate, or profane. It also filters comments from users whose comments are reported, disliked, or deleted.

TikTok says the feature uses AI to understand how the user is blocking and deleting the content. So, if a creator repeatedly deletes or reports certain types of comments, then those kinds of comments are less likely to appear in their comment section.

A new comment tool for TikTok Live will allow creators to block a word from their comments entirely. Plus, users who previously commented the phrase or who comment the phrase in the future will be muted for the creator’s chosen duration.

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TikTok

IMAGE CREDITS:TIKTOK

To help creators better manage messages, TikTok is launching a new professional inbox experience called the “Creator Inbox,” which includes “Unread” and “Starred” folders. Creators can also set up custom responses to address commonly asked questions, and they can create quick replies for sharing these responses with one tap.

TikTok is also launching Creator Chat Room, which allows creators to connect and interact directly with eligible followers on TikTok. Creators and their followers can message back and forth with each other in the Chat Room.

Creator Chat Rooms are available to creators who are at least 18 years old, have at least 10,000 followers, and have either a Subscription or Live Fan Club. Chats are capped at 300 people, and creators can have at least 20 different chats.

Creators will also get access to “Content Check Lite,” which is a new feature that allows users to check if their content is eligible to appear in the For You feed. This way, users can make any necessary changes before posting.

TikTok is also testing a broader Content Check functionality that will allow creators to check if their content adheres to the social network’s Community Guidelines before it goes live on platform.

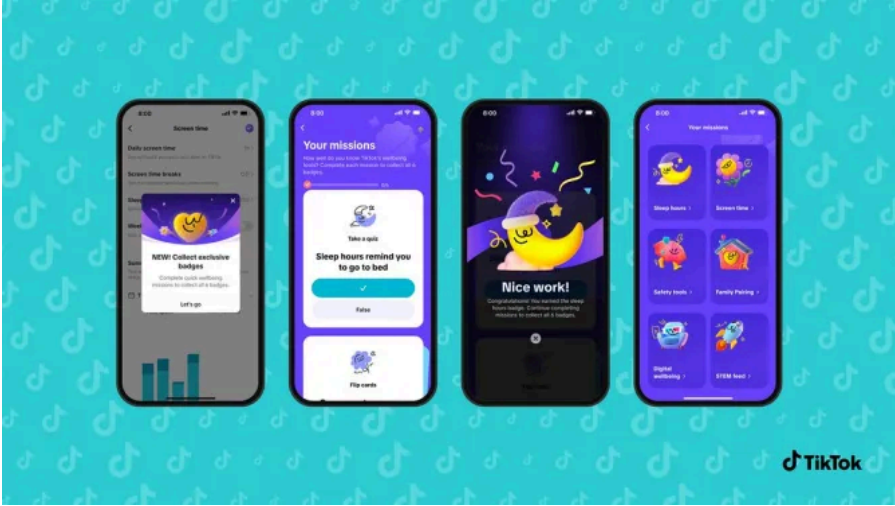


IMAGE CREDITS:TIKTOK

The social network also announced that it’s launching a new feature called “Well-being Missions,” which are series of short quizzes and interactive flash cards to help people develop balanced digital habits. Users earn badges as they complete these missions.

TikTok says it’s building a new in-app dedicated digital well-being experience that will feature tools like breathing exercises, calming audio tracks, and screen time insights to help people recharge.

Topics: [Apps](#) [parental controls](#) [Social](#) [TikTok](#)

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 **Aisha Malik**  
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Aisha is a consumer news reporter at TechCrunch. Prior to joining the publication in 2021, she was a telecom reporte...

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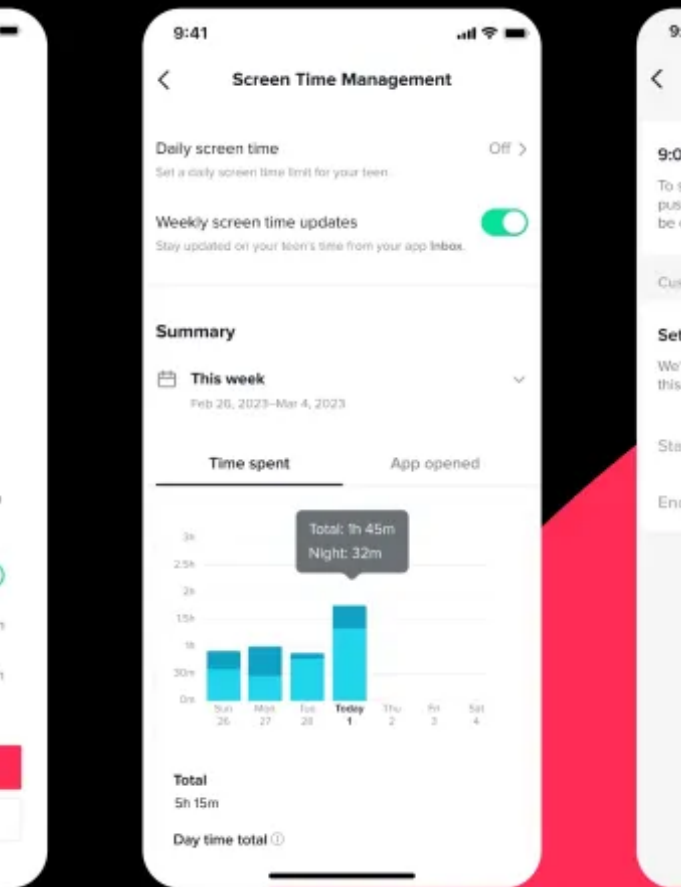


IMAGE CREDITS: TIKTOK

## SOCIAL



# TikTok rolls out new screen time controls, adds new default settings for teens and expands Family Pairing

Aisha Malik — 3:00 AM PST · March 1, 2023

TikTok [announced](#) today that it's introducing new well-being features for teens, families and its broader community. The company is improving its screen time controls with more custom options, introducing new default settings for teen accounts and expanding Family Pairing with more parental controls.

Every account belonging to a user under the age of 18 will soon automatically be set to a 60-minute daily screen time limit. Once the 60-minute limit is reached, teens will be asked to enter a passcode in order to keep scrolling. For users of [TikTok's under-13 experience](#), the daily screen time limit will also

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be set to 60 minutes. If the screen time limit is reached, a parent or guardian will need to set or enter an existing passcode to enable 30 more minutes of watch time.

The app will prompt teens to set a daily screen time limit if they turn off the 60-minute default and spend more than 100 minutes on TikTok in a day. In the company’s first month of testing, it found that this approach increased the use of its screen time management tools by 234%. TikTok will also send every teen account a weekly inbox notification with a recap of their screen time.

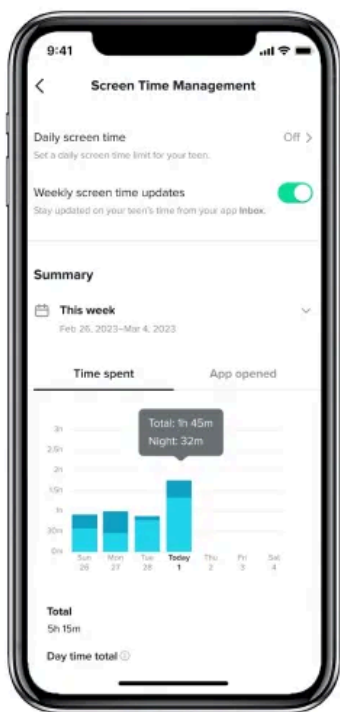


IMAGE CREDITS: TIKTOK

TikTok is also adding new features to its Family Pairing tool, which lets parents link their account to their teen’s to enable content and privacy settings. Most notably, the company said it’s in the early stages of developing a way for caregivers to filter videos with words or hashtags they don’t want their teen to watch. TikTok is in the process of working with parenting, youth and civil society organizations to design this feature.

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In addition, Caregivers are now able to use Family Pairing to customize the daily screen time limit for their teen, including the option to select different time limits depending on the day of the week. For instance, you can allow your teen to have more screen time during the weekends and holidays, while restricting screen time during weekdays.

The company is also bringing its screen time dashboard to Family Pairing. The dashboard includes information about how much time a teen spent on the app during the day and night, along with stats about how many times they opened the app. TikTok says that by proving this information to caregivers directly, they will be able to guide their teens.

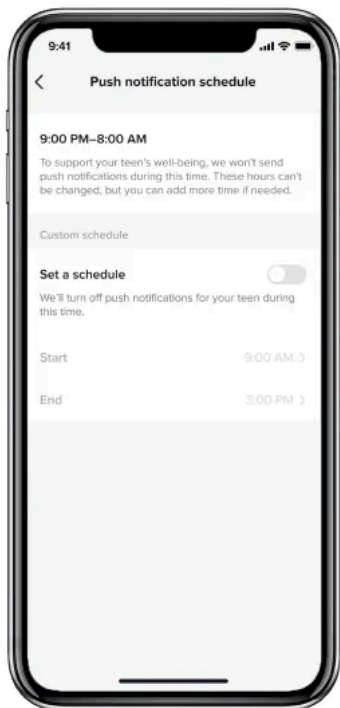


IMAGE CREDITS: TIKTOK

TikTok is also introducing a new setting that enables parents to set a schedule to mute notifications for their teen. It's worth noting that accounts of users aged 13-15 already don't receive push notifications from 9 pm and accounts of users aged 16-17 have push notifications disabled from 10

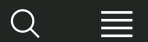


pm. TikTok says it's aware that although notifications help people stay connected, there are times when it's important to be uninterrupted.



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As for its broader community, TikTok says it wants all of its users to feel in control of their experience on the app, which is why it's giving everyone the ability to set their own customized screen time limits for each day of the week and set a schedule to mute notifications. The company is also rolling out a sleep reminder for users to remind themselves when it's time to put the app down and go to sleep.

"We'll continue to invest in improving our current features as well as introducing new tools to help people stay in control as they express their creativity, make meaningful connections, and enjoy culture-defining entertainment," the company said in a [blog post](#).

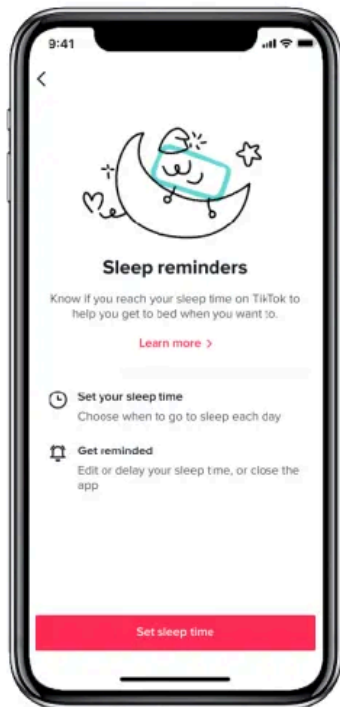


IMAGE CREDITS: TIKTOK

A recent report [revealed](#) that TikTok is the social app kids and teens are spending the most time using throughout the day, even outpacing YouTube. Given its popularity among kids and teens, it's no surprise that TikTok is looking to enhance its well-being features for young users.

Over the past few years, TikTok has faced scrutiny regarding [the app's impact](#) on its youngest users. It's been more than a year after executives from social media platforms, including TikTok, [faced questions from lawmakers](#) during congressional hearings over how their platforms can negatively impact young users. Since then, the company has [released updates](#) focused on minor safety. The new features announced today are part of the app's efforts to appease lawmakers.

# TikTok is crushing YouTube in annual study of kids’ and teens’ app usage



For another year in a row, TikTok has found itself as the social app kids and teens are spending the most time using throughout the day, even outpacing YouTube. According to an ongoing annual review of kids’ and teens’ app usage and behavior globally, the younger demographic — minors and teens ranging in ages from ...

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**Aisha Malik**

Consumer News Reporter | 

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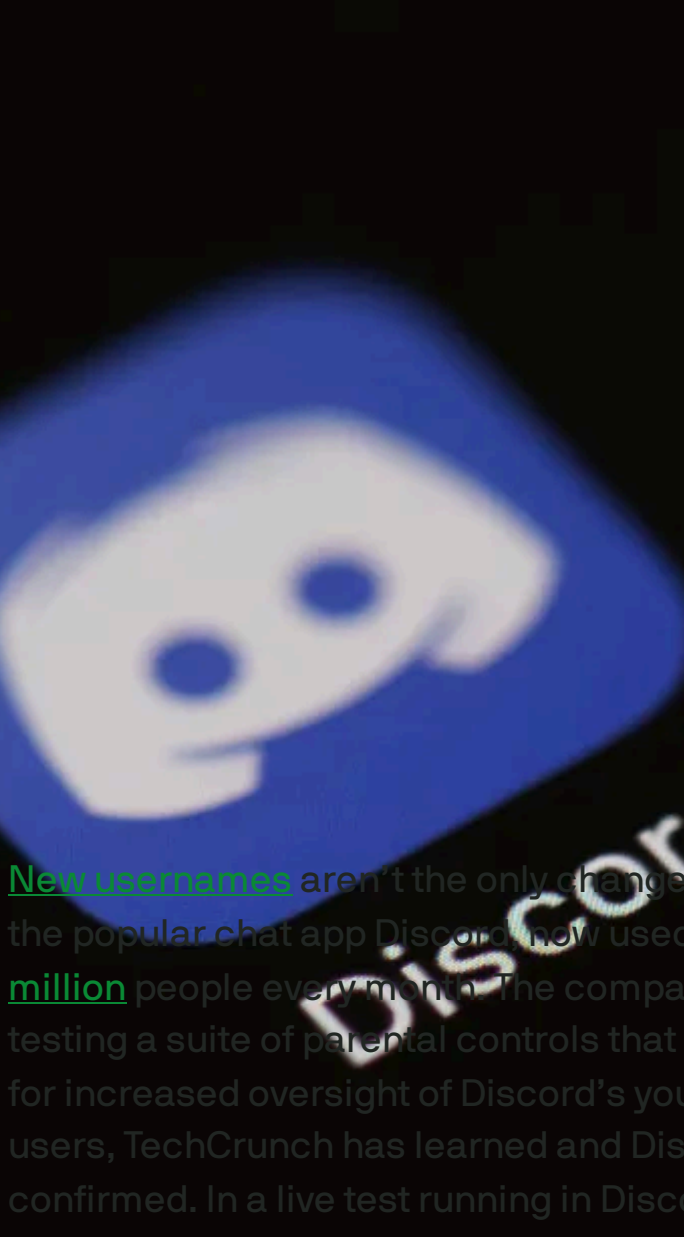
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APPS

# Increased oversight: Discord tests new parental controls for teens

Sarah Perez — 11:11 AM PDT · May 22, 2023



[New usernames](#) aren't the only change coming to the popular chat app Discord, now used by [150 million](#) people every month. The company is also testing a suite of parental controls that would allow for increased oversight of Discord's youngest users, TechCrunch has learned and Discord confirmed. In a live test running in Discord's iOS app in the U.S., the company introduced a new "Family Center" feature, where parents will be able to configure tools that allow them to see the names and avatars of their teen's recently added friends, the servers the teen has joined or participated in and the names and avatars of users they've directly messaged or engaged with in group chats.

However, Discord clarifies in an informational screen, parents will not be able to view the content of their teen's messages or calls in order to respect their privacy.

This approach, which toes a fine line between the need for parental oversight and a minor's right to privacy, is similar to how [Snapchat implemented parental controls](#) in its app last year. Like Discord's system, Snapchat only allows parents insights into

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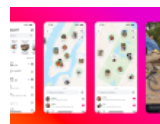
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who their teen is talking to and friending, not what they've typed or the media they've shared.

Users who are part of the Discord test will see the new Family Center hub linked under the app's User Settings section, below the Privacy & Safety and Profiles sections. From here, parents are able to read an overview of the Family Center features and click a button to "Get Started" when they're ready to set things up.

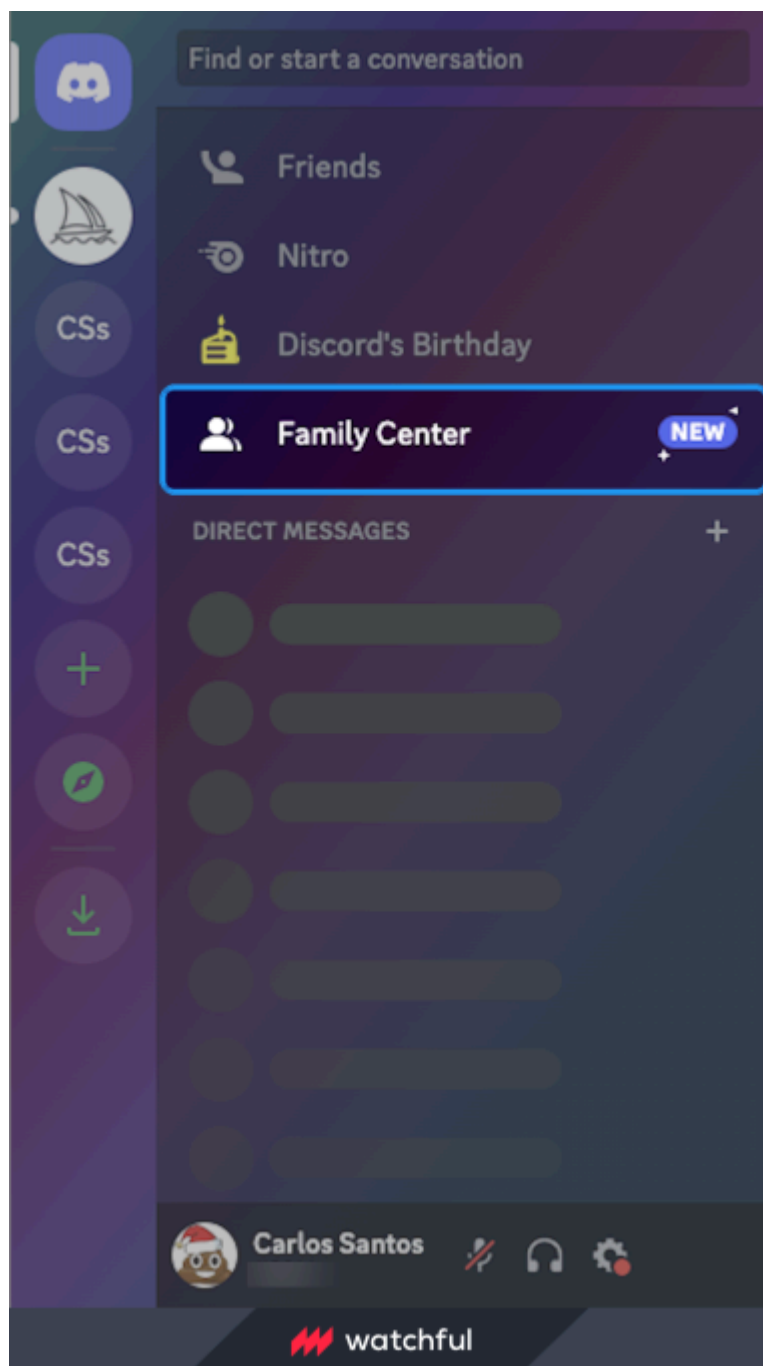


IMAGE CREDITS: DISCORD SCREENSHOT VIA WATCHFUL.AI

Discord explains on this screen that it “built Family Center to provide you with more content on how your teen uses Discord so you can work together on building positive online behaviors.” It then details

the various parental controls, which will allow them to see who their teen is chatting with and friending, and which servers they join and participate in.

Similar to TikTok, parents can scan a QR code provided by the teen to put the account under their supervision.

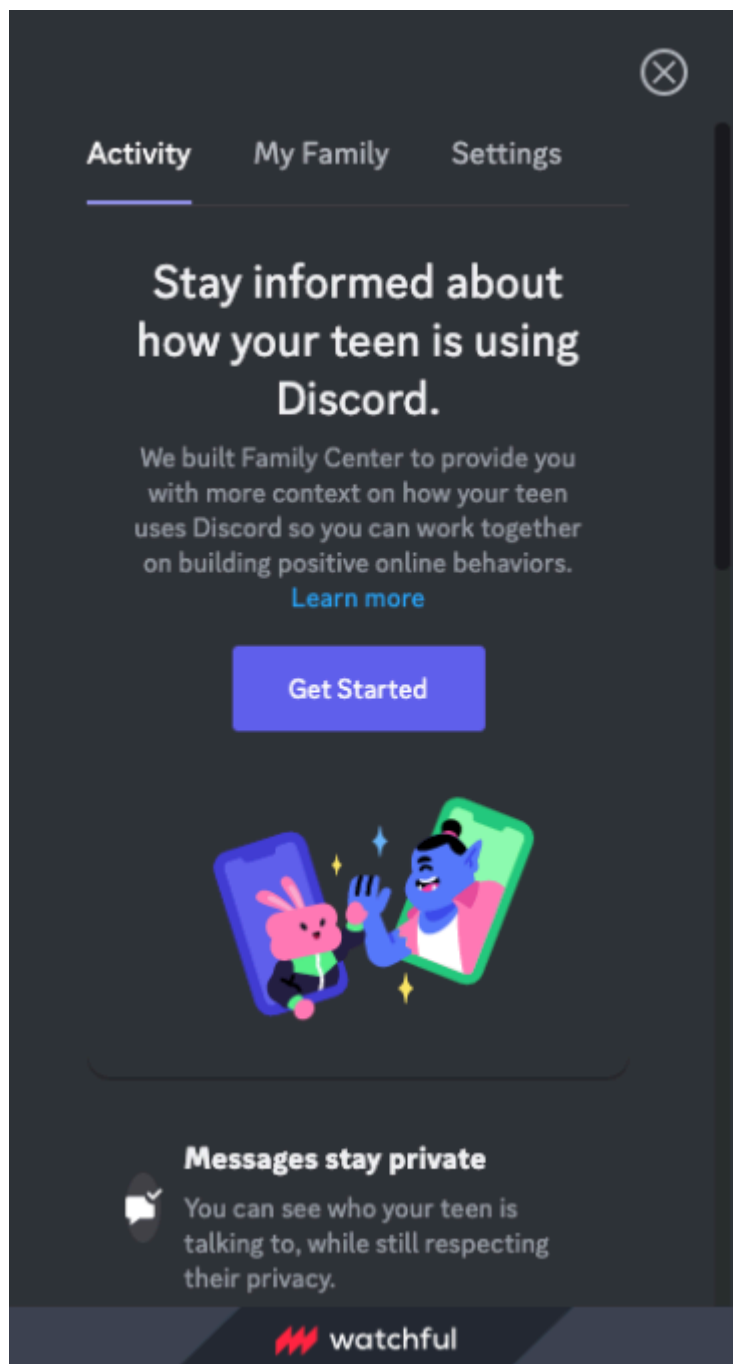


IMAGE CREDITS:

DISCORD SCREENSHOT VIA WATCHFUL.AI

The screenshots were discovered by app intelligence firm [Watchful.ai](https://watchful.ai). In addition, a handful of users [had posted their own screenshots](#) on Twitter when they encountered the new experience earlier this year, or had simply [remarked](#) on the feature when coming across it in the app.



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We reached Discord for comment on the tests, showing them some screenshots from the test. The company confirmed the development but didn't offer a firm commitment as to when or if the parent control feature would actually roll out.

"We're always working to improve our platform and keep users safe, particularly our younger users," a Discord spokesperson said. "We'll let you know if and when something comes of this work," they added.

The company declined to answer our questions about the reach of the tests, or whether it planned to offer the tools outside the U.S., among other things.

IMAGE CREDITS:

DISCORD SCREENSHOT VIA WATCHFUL.AI

Though Discord today is regularly used by a younger, Gen Z crowd, thanks to its roots in being a home for gamers, it's often left out of the larger conversation around the harms to teens caused by social media use. Meanwhile, as execs from [Facebook](#), [Twitter](#), [Instagram](#), [Snap](#), [YouTube](#) and [TikTok](#) have had to testify before Congress on this topic, Discord has been able to sit on the sidelines.

Hoping to get ahead of expected regulations, most major social media companies have since rolled out parental control features for their apps, if they didn't already offer such tools. [YouTube](#) and



[Instagram](#) announced plans for parental controls in 2021, and Instagram finally [launched](#) them in 2022 with other Meta apps to follow. [Snapchat](#) also rolled out parental controls in 2022. And TikTok, which already had parental controls before the congressional inquiries began, has been [beefing them up in recent months](#).

But with the lack of regulation at the federal level, several U.S. states have begun their own laws around social media use, including new restrictions on social media apps in states like [Utah](#) and [Montana](#), as well as broader legislation to protect minors, like [California's Age Appropriate Design Code Act](#), which goes into [effect](#) next year.

Discord, so far, has flown under the radar, despite the warnings from [child safety experts](#), [law enforcement](#) and the [media](#) about the dangers the app poses to minors, [amid reports](#) that [groomers](#) and [sexual predators](#) have been [using the service](#) to target children. The nonprofit organization, the National Center on Sexual Exploitation, even [added Discord](#) to its "Dirty Dozen List" over its failures to "adequately address the sexually exploitative content and activity on its platform," it says.

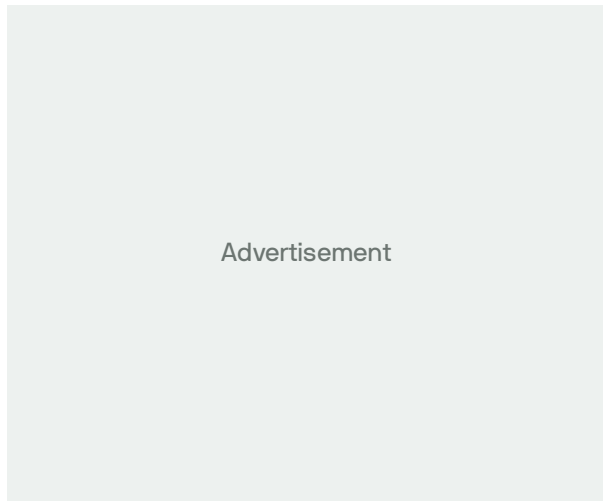
The organization specifically calls out Discord's lack of meaningful age verification technology, insufficient moderation, and inadequate safety settings.

Today, Discord offers its users access to [an online safety center](#) that guides users and parents on how to manage a safe Discord account or server, but it doesn't go so far as to actually provide parents with tools to monitor their child's use of the service or block them from joining servers or communicating with unknown persons. The new parental controls won't address the latter two concerns, however, but they are at least an acknowledgment that some sort of parental controls are needed.

This is a shift from Discord’s earlier position on the matter, as the company [told The Wall Street Journal in early 2021](#) its philosophy was to put users first, not their parents, and said it wasn’t planning on adding such a feature.

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## Sarah Perez

Consumer News Editor | [X](#) [Twitter](#) [Email](#) [LinkedIn](#)

Sarah has worked as a reporter for TechCrunch since August 2011. She joined the company after having...

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